HTML Basics: Tags, Links, Images and Lists

The building blocks of every web page.

Web Dev | Beginner | Ages 9–16

InfiBee Coders

💡 The Big Idea

- HTML (HyperText Markup Language) is the structure of a web page: headings, text, links, pictures and lists.
- You write tags like `<p>` to tell the browser what each piece of content is.
- Most tags come in pairs: an opening tag `<p>` and a closing tag `</p>` with a slash.
- Save the file with the ending `.html` and open it in any browser.
- HTML is the skeleton. CSS adds style and JavaScript adds behaviour.

🏗️ Page Structure

- `<!DOCTYPE html>` tells the browser this is modern HTML.
- `<html>` wraps everything. Inside are `<head>` (information) and `<body>` (what you see).
- `<title>` in the head sets the browser tab name.
- `<meta charset="UTF-8">` makes letters and emojis show correctly.
- Everything visible goes inside `<body>`.

✍️ Text Tags

- Headings: `<h1>` is the biggest, `<h6>` the smallest. Use one `<h1>` per page.
- `<p>` is a paragraph. `<br>` is a line break and `<hr>` draws a line.
- `<strong>` makes text bold and `<em>` makes it italic.
- `<div>` groups blocks of content. `<span>` groups inline text.
- `<!-- comment -->` is a note the browser ignores.

🔗 Links, Images and Lists

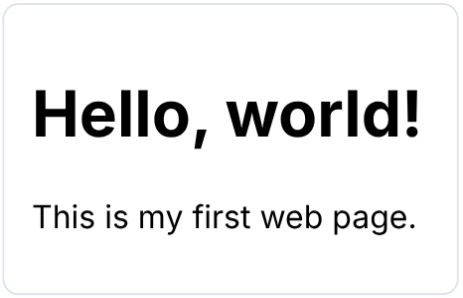
- Link: `<a href="page.html">text</a>`. Add `target="_blank"` to open in a new tab.
- Image: `<img src="cat.jpg" alt="A cat">`. The alt text describes it for screen readers.
- Bullets: `<ul>` with `<li>` items. Numbers: `<ol>` with `<li>` items.
- Table: `<table>`, rows `<tr>`, headings `<th>`, cells `<td>`.
- Form bits: `<input>`, `<button>`, `<label>`, `<textarea>`.

💻 Code Examples

The smallest web page HTML

```html
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <title>My First Page</title>
</head>
<body>
  <h1>Hello, world!</h1>
  <p>This is my first web page.</p>
</body>
</html>
```

▶ What you see:

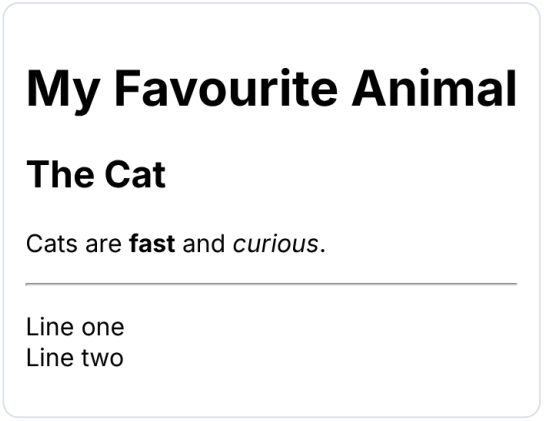


The title appears on the browser tab. Everything in the body is shown on the page.

Headings, text and emphasis HTML

```html
<h1>My Favourite Animal</h1>
<h2>The Cat</h2>
<p>Cats are <strong>fast</strong> and
<em>curious</em>.</p>
<hr>
<p>Line one<br>Line two</p>
```

▶ What you see:

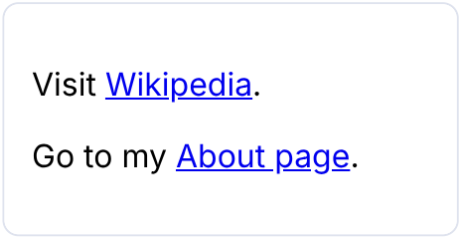


Headings get smaller from h1 to h6.

Links HTML

```html
<p>Visit <a href="https://www.wikipedia.org"
target="_blank">Wikipedia</a>.</p>
<p>Go to my <a href="about.html">About
page</a>.</p>
```

▶ What you see:



The first link goes to another website. The second links to a page in the same folder.

Lists HTML

```
<h3>Shopping list</h3>
<ul>
  <li>Apples</li>
  <li>Bread</li>
  <li>Milk</li>
</ul>
<h3>Steps</h3>
<ol>
  <li>Wake up</li>
  <li>Code</li>
  <li>Sleep</li>
</ol>
```

▶ What you see:

Shopping list

- Apples
- Bread
- Milk

Steps

1. Wake up
2. Code
3. Sleep

ul gives bullets and ol gives numbers.

A table HTML

```
<table border="1" cellpadding="6">
  <tr><th>Name</th><th>Score</th></tr>
  <tr><td>Aarav</td><td>88</td></tr>
  <tr><td>Mia</td><td>95</td></tr>
</table>
```

▶ What you see:

Name	Score
Aarav	88
Mia	95

th is a heading cell, td is a normal cell.

A simple form HTML

```
<label>Your name:</label><br>
<input type="text" placeholder="Type here">
<br><br>
<button>Send</button>
```

▶ What you see:

Your name:
Type here
Send

Forms collect information from the visitor.

An image HTML

```html
<img src="cat.jpg" alt="A grey cat sleeping on a sofa" width="300">
```

▶ What you see:
The picture cat.jpg from the same folder is shown 300 pixels wide. If the file is missing, the alt text appears instead.

📚 Key Terms

HTML
The language that gives a web page its structure.

Body
The part you see in the browser.

Tag
A keyword in angle brackets, like .

Link
Text that takes you to another page.

Element
An opening tag, content and closing tag together.

alt text
A description of an image for screen readers.

Attribute
Extra information in a tag, like href or src.

Nesting
Putting one element inside another.

Head
The part with page information.

Browser
A program like Chrome that shows web pages.

🧮 Quick Reference

```
<h1>Title</h1>
<p>Paragraph</p>
<a href="url">link</a>
<img src="pic.jpg" alt="text">
<ul><li>item</li></ul>
<ol><li>item</li></ol>
<strong>bold</strong> <em>italic</em>
<!-- comment -->
```

✏️ Worked Examples

Q: Make a page with your name as a heading and a short paragraph about you.

A: Put <h1>Your Name</h1> and About me... inside <body>, save as index.html and open it in your browser.

Q: Link to another page called hobbies.html.

A: My hobbies. Both files must be in the same folder.

Q: Make a numbered list of 3 steps.

A: Use <ol> with three <li> items.

🚫 Common Mistakes

- Forgetting the closing tag, like `</p>`, so the layout breaks.
- Writing `<a>` without `href`, so the link goes nowhere.
- Missing the file extension, saving as `index` instead of `index.html`.
- Wrong file name or folder in `src` or `href`, so the image or page does not load.
- Forgetting `alt` on images.

👨‍👩‍👧 Parent Corner

- You only need a free text editor and a browser. Notepad plus Chrome is enough to start.
- Ask your child to make a one page website about a hobby.
- Show them how to right click and choose View Page Source on a real website.
- Talk about tags like labels on boxes: they tell the browser what is inside.
- Encourage small changes and refreshing the page to see the result.

🎯 Quick Check

1. What does HTML stand for?

✅ HyperText Markup Language.

2. Which tag makes the biggest heading?

✅ <h1>.

3. Which attribute gives the address of a link?

✅ href.

4. What is alt text for?

✅ Describing an image for people who cannot see it.

5. Which tag makes a bullet list?

✅ with <li> items.